LAF YOMI

Bekhorot 44 · November 01, 2026

ON TODAY'S DAF

Bekhorot 44 continues מומין אלו — the eye blemishes: eyes too high or too low, the blind, the tearing, the mismatched. Then disproportion itself: calf eyes and goose eyes, noses measured against a pinky, sponge ears, teeth that fell out. And 44b: Moshe's ten-cubit height, the urination sugyot, and מרוח אשך argued four ways.

עיוור · THE BLIND PERSON IS NOT USELESS



1. The Torah calls a blind animal עורת but a blind person עיוור. Rav Zalman Sorotzkin asks why two words for the same blindness: a blind animal is useless, but a blind person is not — his mind still works, and he can still function.

“Same blindness, different word, different dignity: the animal is עורת, written off — the person is עיוור, still thinking, still learning, still a person.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 44a · עיוור — why a blind person gets a different word than a blind animal · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 3:22

מחסרייתא · THE KOHEN'S GLASSES



2. If any impaired vision is a mum, what about a kohen who wears glasses? Rav Wosner rules the glasses themselves are fine — they restore proper vision. But may he wear them during the avodah?

“Rashi calls tefillin an extra garment — יתור בגדים — so glasses would be too; Tosafot says tefillin aren't kohanic garb, so glasses pass.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 44a · מחסרייתא — impaired vision, and whether a kohen may wear glasses · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 6:28

זגדין · THE DEMONSTRATION THAT OFFENDED RAV YEHUDA



3. What is a זגדן? Rav Huna, sitting before Rav Yehuda, demonstrated: one eye like mine, and one eye like Rav Yehuda's — and Rav Yehuda took offense.

“Rashi: his eyes were misshapen, so it stung. Tosafot: Rav Huna was short and Rav Yehuda tall — and tall and skinny was taken as a sign of not being smart.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 44a · זגדין — one eye like ours, one eye like theirs · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 9:39

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משה רבינו עשר אמות · THE LADDER, AND THE BAAL MUM



4. Rav says Moshe Rabbeinu was ten amot tall — he spread the tent over the Mishkan, and the Mishkan was ten amot high. The Pardes Yosef asks: maybe Moshe just stood on a ladder?

“No ladder: it was avodah, and avodah allows no chatzitzah underfoot. Then Rav Shimi: you've made Moshe a baal mum! Rav: Shimi — I meant the amah of the boards.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 44a · משה רבינו עשר אמות — ten cubits tall, and the ladder that wasn't · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 19:32

שמואל איצריך · FOUR HUNDRED ZUZ TO RETRACT THE STORY



5. Shmuel had to urinate on the Shabbat of the festival drasha, so they spread a sheet around him for privacy. His father offered him four hundred zuz — go and retract the story.

“You get a sheet, Shmuel — but the ordinary Jew has no sheet-bearers, and will hold it in until he endangers himself. Hush money for a public-health lesson.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 44b · שמואל איצריך — the sheet, the drasha, and 400 zuz · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 27:46

מר בר רב אשי · ON THE BRIDGE



6. Mar bar Rav Ashi was crossing a bridge when he needed to urinate — so he urinated. They warned him: your mother-in-law is coming!

“His answer: באודנא — I'd do it even in her ear. When holding it in is a sakana, not even a mother-in-law on the bridge changes the halacha.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 44b · מר בר רב אשי — on the bridge, and the mother-in-law · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 28:35